

Ups and Downs of Life

For years, Kenji **toiled on** his rice field, **barely** making **ends meet** for him and his family. Yet he had no complaints. He was happy with whatever little he could afford. One day, his horse ran away. That **spelt doom** for any farmer. Kenji's neighbours came to his home to express their **sympathies**.

"Such bad luck!" they said, shaking their heads **woefully**.

"Maybe," said the farmer **mysteriously**.



The next day, his son shouted with **glee**, "Father, look! Our horse has returned!" Sure enough, their horse **sauntered** into the farm, bringing in three other wild horses **in tow**.

"What good **fortune!**" Kenji's neighbours **exulted**.

"Maybe," replied the old farmer.

The farmer's son was excited at seeing the new horses and tried to **mount** one of them. The **untamed** horse **bucked**, throwing him off the **saddle**. The youth **groaned** in pain as his leg broke.

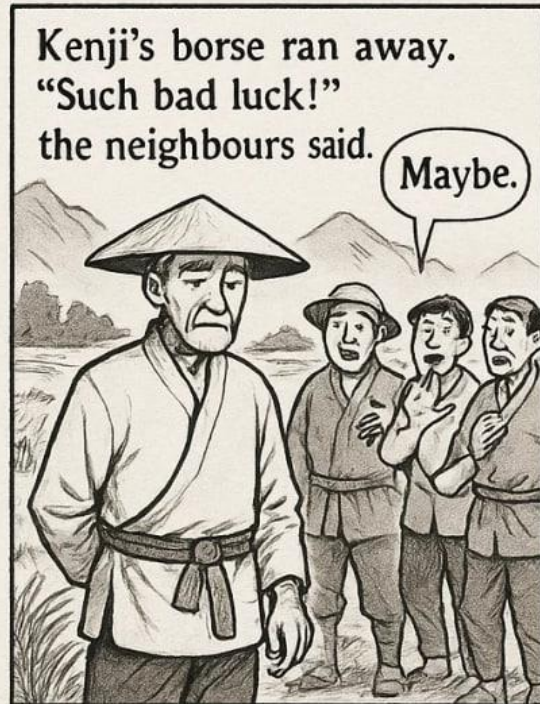
The neighbours lost no time in **condoling** his latest **misfortune**, to which Kenji **merely shrugged** his shoulders and said, "Maybe."

The **following** day, the **ruling** shogun's men **scoured** the village to **draft able-bodied** young men into the army. The farmer's son was **excused** because of his injury, saving him from the **dreadful prospect** of fighting and dying in an **unwanted** war.

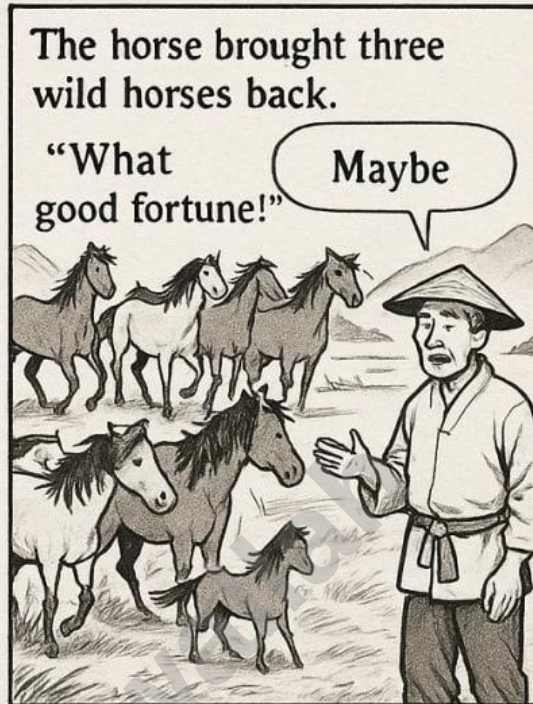
When the neighbours congratulated the farmer on how lucky he was, Kenji simply repeated, "Maybe."

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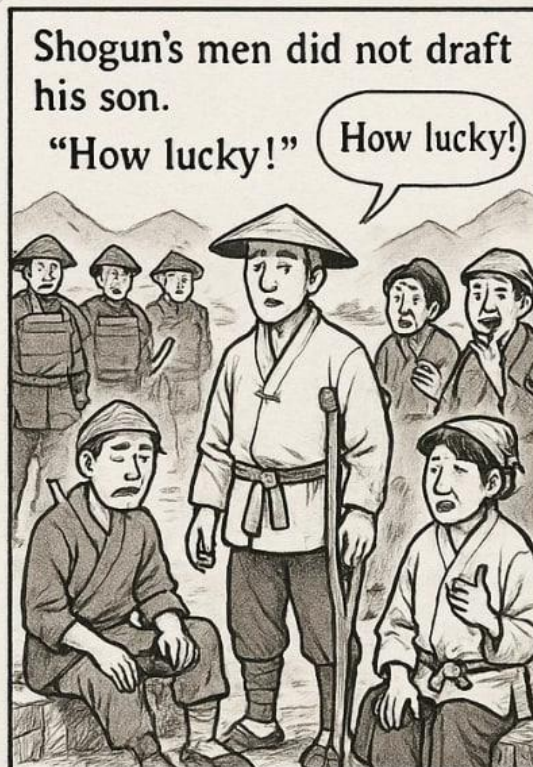
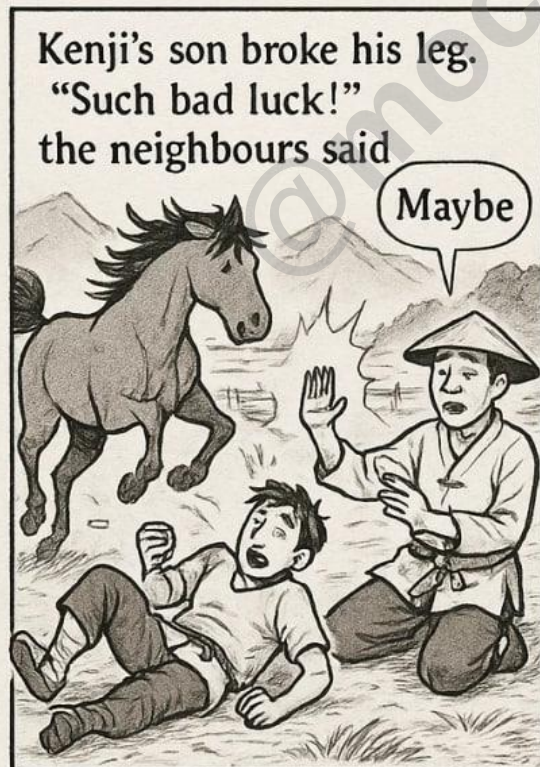




Rertji' horse ran away.
"Such bad luck!"
the neighbours said.



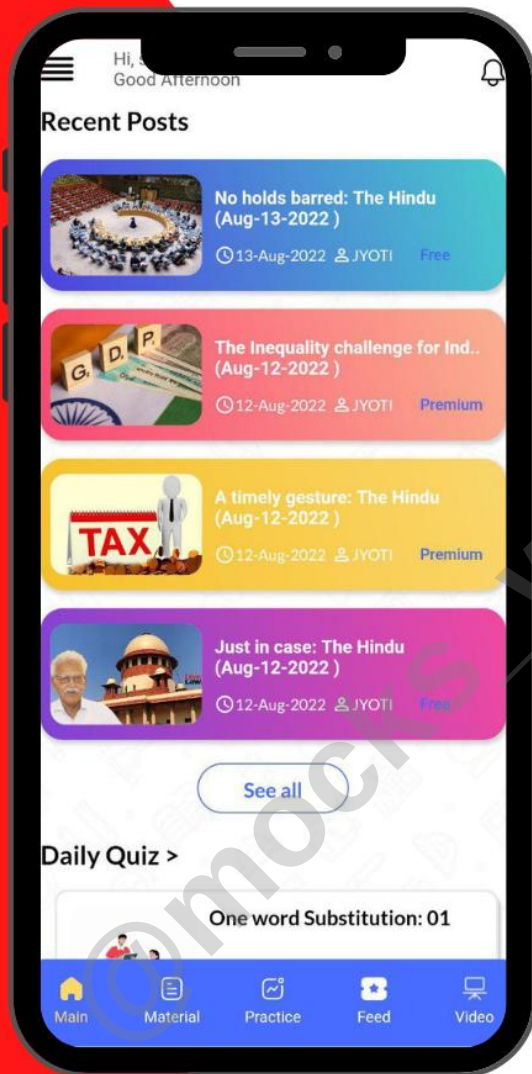
Kenji's son broke his leg.
"Such bad luck!"
the neighbours said



Vocabulary

1. **Ups and Downs** (phrase) – highs and lows, peaks and valleys, ebbs and flows, vicissitudes, swings उतार-चढ़ाव
2. **Toil** (verb) – labor, slog, drudge, grind, travail कठिन परिश्रम करना
3. **Barely** (adverb) – hardly, scarcely, just, narrowly, only just मुश्किल से/कठिनाई से
4. **Ends meet** (phrase) – cover expenses, get by, scrape by, pay the bills, keep the wolf from the door गुज़ारा चलाना
5. **Spell doom** (phrase) – portend disaster, bode ill, signal ruin, mean catastrophe, foreshadow collapse विनाश का संकेत देना/अशुभ सिद्ध होना
6. **Sympathy** (noun) – condolence, commiseration, compassion, pity, fellow feeling सहानुभूति/संवेदना
7. **Woefully** (adverb) – sadly, lamentably, grievously, deplorably, miserably दुखपूर्वक/दयनीय रूप से
8. **Mysteriously** (adverb) – enigmatically, cryptically, inexplicably, puzzlingly, opaquely रहस्यमय ढंग से
9. **Glee** (noun) – delight, joy, elation, jubilation, exultation हर्ष/आनंद
10. **Saunter** (verb) – stroll, amble, meander, ramble, mosey टहलना/धीरे-धीरे चलना
11. **In tow** (phrase) – following along, tagging along, in train, trailing, in company साथ-साथ/पीछे-पीछे
12. **Fortune** (noun) – luck, fate, providence, serendipity, windfall भाग्य/सौभाग्य
13. **Exult** (verb) – rejoice, revel, triumph, celebrate, glory अत्यंत प्रसन्न होना/उल्लासित होना
14. **Mount** (verb) – get on, climb onto, ascend, bestride, hop on सवारी पर चढ़ना
15. **Untamed** (adjective) – wild, feral, unbroken, undomesticated, savage अनियंत्रित/अवशिष्ट
16. **Buck** (verb) – rear, jolt, throw, pitch, kick (off) उछलना/झटका देकर गिरा देना
17. **Saddle** (noun) – riding seat, horse saddle, tack, pad, pommel-and-cantle assembly काठी
18. **Groan** (verb) – moan, lament, wail, grunt, cry out कराहना
19. **Condole** (verb) – commiserate, sympathize, console, offer condolences, express sorrow शोक व्यक्त करना/संवेदना देना
20. **Misfortune** (noun) – bad luck, adversity, mishap, calamity, ill luck दुर्भाग्य/आकस्मिक विपत्ति

21. **Merely** (adverb) – only, just, simply, purely, nothing more than मात्र/केवल
22. **Shrug** (verb) – dismiss, brush off, shrug off, disregard, make light of कंधे उचकाकर टाल देना/उपेक्षा करना
23. **Following** (preposition) – after, subsequent to, ensuing, post, in the wake of के बाद/परवर्ती
24. **Ruling** (adjective) – governing, reigning, incumbent, dominant, prevailing सत्तारूढ़/शासनरत
25. **Scour** (verb) – comb, search, sweep, trawl, ransack खंगालना/ढूँढ़ मारना
26. **Draft** (verb) – conscript, enlist, call up, recruit, muster जबरन भर्ती करना/सेना में बुलाना
27. **Able-bodied** (adjective) – fit, healthy, robust, strong, sound बलिष्ठ/पूर्णतः कार्यक्षम
28. **Excuse** (of) (verb) – exempt, spare, absolve, release, pardon (from) छूट देना/मुक्त करना
29. **Dreadful** (adjective) – terrible, dire, horrific, ghastly, appalling भयानक/भयावह
30. **Prospect** (noun) – possibility, likelihood, outlook, chance, hope संभाव्यता/संभावित परिदृश्य
31. **Unwanted** (adjective) – undesired, unwelcome, unsolicited, uninvited, needless अवांछित/अनचाहा



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